

DAILY PRACTICE: DAY 20260628 - ADVERTISING AIMED AT YOUNG CONSUMERS

(Level: Reading B1 - Writing A1)

Student Name:

Time Allowed: 50 mins

WARM-UP / KHỞI ĐỘNG

Trả lời ngắn gọn các câu hỏi sau bằng tiếng Việt hoặc tiếng Anh trước khi đọc bài:

1. Bạn sử dụng mạng xã hội bao nhiêu giờ mỗi ngày? Bạn thường xem nội dung gì? (How many hours a day do you use social media? What kind of content do you usually watch?)
2. Theo bạn, mạng xã hội có tác động như thế nào đến sức khỏe tâm thần của giới trẻ? (How do you think social media affects the mental health of young people?)
3. Bạn đã bao giờ mua một sản phẩm vì thấy quảng cáo trên mạng xã hội chưa? (Have you ever bought a product because you saw an advertisement on social media?)

I. READING PASSAGE

Social Media, Advertising, and Teenage Health

(Adapted from BBC Learning English - 6 Minute English, "Social media and teenage health", 23 November 2023)

Social media platforms are now one of the most powerful tools that **advertisers** use to reach young people. Every time a teenager opens an app, they are **fed** a stream of personalised content — posts, videos, and **advertisements** — selected by an **algorithm**, which is a complex set of rules and calculations that decides what each user sees. These **algorithms** are designed to keep users **engaged** for as long as possible because more time on the app means more **revenue** for the company.

However, **adolescents**, who are young people between the ages of 10 and 19, may be especially **vulnerable** to the effects of social media. Research suggests that teenagers who spend more than three hours a day on social media platforms face double the risk of developing depression and anxiety. This is partly because the content that **algorithms promote** often includes idealised images of beauty, success, and lifestyle that are unrealistic and can make young people feel inadequate.

The relationship between social media and advertising is, in fact, a cycle. Platforms profit from showing **advertisements**, so they use **algorithms** to keep young users **engaged** for longer. The longer a teenager stays on the platform, the more **advertisements** they see, and the more data the company collects about their habits and preferences. This data is then sold to companies which use it to create **targeted** advertising — messages designed specifically for a particular person based on their interests, age, and **consumer behaviour**.

Experts argue that the **onus** — the responsibility — for protecting young people should not fall only on parents. While many parents try to manage their children's **screen time**, it can feel like a **losing battle** against powerful technology companies. Some scientists and health professionals are calling on governments to **regulate** social media platforms and limit how much **addictive** design is allowed. A few countries are already beginning to pass new laws restricting the use of social media by children under a certain age.

The question that remains is whether laws alone are enough to protect the next generation of **consumers** from the **persuasive** power of digital advertising.

Source: Adapted from BBC Learning English – 6 Minute English - "Social media and teenage health" (November 23, 2023)
URL: https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/6-minute-english_2023/ep-231123

II. IELTS READING QUESTIONS (13 QUESTIONS)

Questions 1–5: Choose the correct letter, A, B, C, or D, for questions 1–5.

1. What is the primary purpose of algorithms on social media platforms, according to the passage?
 - A. To protect teenagers from harmful content.
 - B. To keep users engaged for as long as possible.
 - C. To help teenagers find educational material.
 - D. To limit the amount of advertising shown.
2. What does the word "**fed**" mean in the context of the passage?
 - A. Given food to eat.
 - B. Given content selected by the platform.
 - C. Forced to watch advertising videos.
 - D. Sold products by companies.
3. According to the research cited in the passage, what is the risk for teenagers who spend more than three hours a day on social media?
 - A. They spend more money on products they see online.
 - B. They are more likely to share personal information.
 - C. They are twice as likely to develop depression and anxiety.
 - D. They are more creative and connected.
4. What does the phrase "**targeted advertising**" mean in the passage?
 - A. Advertising shown on television at specific times.
 - B. Advertising aimed at older adults only.
 - C. Advertising designed for a specific person based on their data.
 - D. Advertising that uses government-approved messages.
5. What is the writer's view in the final paragraph?
 - A. Laws are the only solution needed to protect young consumers.
 - B. It is still uncertain whether laws alone can protect young people from digital advertising.
 - C. Governments should ban all social media platforms immediately.
 - D. Parents are completely responsible for protecting children online.

Questions 6–9: Headings:

6. Paragraph 1: _____
7. Paragraph 2: _____
8. Paragraph 3: _____

9. Paragraph 4: _____

Questions 10–13: Do the following statements agree with the information given in the reading passage? Write:

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

10. Social media companies use algorithms to decide which content each user sees.
11. All teenagers who use social media more than three hours a day will develop a mental health condition.
12. Social media platforms sell user data to companies for advertising purposes.
13. The writer believes that a combination of parental control, government regulation, and platform responsibility is the ideal solution to protecting young consumers. (*)

III. QUESTIONS FOR GRAMMAR (30 QUESTIONS)

Questions 14–23: Complete each sentence using the correct relative pronoun (who, which, that, where) and decide whether the clause is defining (D) or non-defining (ND).

14. Adolescents are people _____ are between the ages of 10 and 19. ()
15. An algorithm, _____ is a complex set of rules, decides what users see online. ()
16. The data _____ platforms collect is sold to advertising companies. ()
17. Professor Sridhar, _____ is a health expert, argues that parents cannot fight platforms alone. ()
18. Social media platforms are places _____ young people spend several hours every day. ()
19. The law _____ was passed in 2023 aims to protect children under 16. ()
20. Targeted advertising, _____ uses personal data, can feel very persuasive. ()
21. The teenagers _____ spend the most time online see the most advertisements. ()
22. Algorithms, _____ are designed by engineers, prioritise content _____ keeps users engaged. ()
23. The country _____ social media regulation is strictest is one _____ some experts believe all nations should follow. () (*)

Questions 24–33: Fill in the blanks with the correct contrast linker: while, whereas, by contrast, in contrast, although, however, nevertheless.

24. Some teenagers understand the risks of social media, _____ others are completely unaware.
25. Spending one hour on social media may be fine. _____, spending more than three hours increases health risks significantly.
26. Parents try to limit screen time; _____, powerful algorithms make this difficult.
27. _____ girls tend to compare themselves to beauty influencers, boys are more likely to be affected by gaming content.
28. Many teenagers feel addicted to their phones. _____, they often say they do not want to reduce their screen time.

29. European governments have introduced some social media regulations. Asian governments, _____, have mostly avoided strict rules so far.
30. _____ social media advertising is very effective, it also raises serious ethical questions.
31. One group spends 2 hours on social media daily. The second group, _____, averages 5 hours per day.
32. Social media companies earn billions from advertising; _____, only a small fraction of their users are fully aware of this.
33. Social media is seen as highly beneficial for connecting people and sharing ideas, _____ it is also one of the greatest sources of anxiety for today's adolescents. (*)

Questions 34–43: Combine each pair of sentences using the grammar structure in brackets.

34. Social media platforms have powerful algorithms. The algorithms decide what content users see. [Defining relative clause with 'which']
35. The research shows teenagers are at risk. These teenagers spend more than 3 hours online. [Defining relative clause with 'who']
36. Snapchat is very popular among young people. It is used by 90% of 13 to 24-year-olds. [Non-defining relative clause]
37. Parents try to limit screen time. It is very hard to compete with technology companies. [contrast linker: 'although']
38. Government regulation can help protect young people. It cannot solve the problem completely on its own. [contrast linker: 'while']
39. Targeted advertising uses personal data. It creates messages for a specific person. [Defining relative clause with 'that']
40. Some young people are very media-literate. Others easily believe what they see online. [contrast linker: 'whereas']
41. Professor Sridhar studies public health. She says the onus is on governments, not just parents. [Non-defining relative clause with 'who']
42. The country introduced a law restricting social media use. Young people there showed improvements in mental health. [Non-defining relative clause with 'where'] (*)
43. Platforms earn more revenue from users who stay online longer. This creates a direct conflict between profit and user wellbeing. [Combine using 'which' to add a comment on the entire previous idea] (*)

IV. QUESTIONS FOR WRITING (5 TASKS)

Task 1: Word Ordering (Sắp xếp từ thành câu hoàn chỉnh)

Rearrange the words to form complete sentences:

a) young / to / reach / platforms / use / social media / advertisers / people.

Answer:

b) algorithms / what / users / decides / see / content / an / each.

Answer:

c) governments / limit / some / time / on / screen / trying / are / teenagers' / to.

Answer:

Task 2: Using contrast linkers

Write 3 sentences combining ideas using contrast linkers (while / whereas / although / however). Use the topic of social media and young people.

Answer:

Task 3: Short opinion paragraph (B1 level stretch)

() Write a short paragraph (40-60 words) giving your opinion: Do you think governments should limit how much time teenagers spend on social media? Why or why not?*

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Task 4: Using relative clauses in context

Write 3 sentences about the effects of social media advertising on teenagers. Use a relative clause in at least one sentence.

Answer:

Task 5: Controlled production

Complete these sentence starters using the vocabulary and ideas from today's lesson:

a) Algorithms are designed to...

Answer:

b) Teenagers who spend too much time on social media...

Answer:

c) One reason why governments are beginning to regulate social media is...

Answer: